

KEZAH KAYITESI

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SUMMARY

Kezah Kayitesi is an intrapreneur passionate about creating inclusion, catalyzing development and empowering marginalized communities across Africa through Innovation Technology (IT).

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

Stanford University – Silicon Valley, California <i>MSE Certification; Innovation and Entrepreneurship</i>	January 2023 – December 2023
One League University – Silicon Valley, California <i>MBA; Business Management & Entrepreneurship</i>	January 2022 – December 2023
African Leadership University – Kigali, Rwanda <i>BA International Business and Trade – 1st Class Honors</i>	September 2017 – December 2020

SKILLS

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| • Design Thinking | • Data Analysis | • Investment Management |
| • Research | • Negotiations | • Business Modeling |
| • UX/UI Design; Figma | • Growth Strategy | • Risk Management |
| • Venture Creation | • Intellectual Curiosity | • Database Management |

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder & Solutions Architect <i>Independent Venture Portfolio – Kigali, Rwanda</i>	January 2026 – Present
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Designing and building sovereign data infrastructure across four sectors — supply chain, education, health and capital markets. Each venture treats data blindness as the root cause of a development failure, and engineers the system that makes the blind spot measurable. Work spans problem research, systems architecture, database and API design, product design, financial modelling, and government and private-sector engagement from concept through MVP.

- **BEV Digital** — FMCG traceability and supply chain intelligence. Designed a national product authentication system assigning cryptographic (HMAC-SHA256) unit identity to every product at the factory, recording each custody handoff on an append-only ledger. Architected five role-based portals (manufacturer, distributor, retailer, consumer, regulator) and a live API triangulation hub integrating the national revenue authority, standards bureau/FDA and development board for sub-2-second automated compliance checks. Addresses a \$2.1B FMCG market in which 80% of trade is invisible to authority, converting verified scan history into distributor credit scoring that unlocks zero-collateral inventory financing. Structured a three-layer tax formalisation pathway and a proof of concept with a national beverage manufacturer.
- **SOMA 1** — National digital curriculum platform (submitted for ministerial review). Authored the concept note and system design for a government-administered platform delivering Rwanda's highest-performing primary teachers to all 3,831 primary schools simultaneously, on the national timetable. Built around a master-teacher content engine, offline-capable local content servers and solar screens for off-grid schools, a facilitation model repositioning 63,046 teachers from content delivery to classroom facilitation, and a learning analytics dashboard giving the ministry near real-time visibility of which learning objectives are failing and where. Targets an 8x provincial literacy gap (4% vs 32% P3 English benchmark) at a fully costed \$1.80 per student per year, with a 70|30 architecture designed to extend into an East African curriculum commons.
- **Med-i** — Patient-owned medical records and physician intelligence network. Designed a three-layer health data platform: a portable lifetime patient record under patient consent control, a verified physician network for case pooling and diaspora specialist consultation, and a population health intelligence layer for outbreak detection and resource planning. Architected the consent model (expiring session codes, granular field-level sharing, immutable cryptographically signed audit log, emergency override) alongside AES-256 encryption, zero-trust access and in-country data residency — resolving the tension between individual patient autonomy and the aggregate visibility governments need to plan health resources.
- **Kesho** — Savings-to-investment infrastructure for African capital markets. Designed a two-layer marketplace connecting fragmented African capital to institutional-grade assets: a USSD-first layer digitising informal savings groups into verified, KYC'd liquidity pools with a portable digital identity, feeding an investment layer where financial institutions originate and tokenise assets accessible from \$1 through licensed custodians. Built the end-to-end

settlement architecture, five-stream revenue model and regulatory pathway, addressing \$96B in annual remittances of which under 25% is productively invested against a \$100B continental infrastructure financing gap.

Associate

January 2025 – June 2025

Open Capital Advisors (OCA) – Kampala, Uganda

- Contributed to the development and implementation of a comprehensive ERP utilization strategy for Aptech, a rapidly expanding, women-led EPC in clean energy. Assisted in designing a data-driven framework to identify growth opportunities, define KPIs, and integrate performance validation systems. Supported user adoption through tailored training programs, ensuring alignment with business goals and enhancing operational efficiency across global subsidiaries.
- Led Rwanda's workstream for an AfDB project focused on studying and engaging women in renewable energy, identifying key barriers to representation and crafting strategies with diverse stakeholders. Facilitated an extensive primary and secondary study, bringing together regulators, entrepreneurs, and other key players, and contributed to a study (to be published). Organized a successful dissemination meeting, with a focus on productive use of energy (PUE), cold storage, and solar home systems (SHS).

Director of Programs

September 2025 – December 2025

Never Again Rwanda (NAR) – Kigali, Rwanda

- Facilitated youth-led participatory research initiatives that engaged over 2,500 young people across Rwanda in dialogues on governance, peacebuilding, and civic participation. Led the implementation of Participatory Action Research (PAR), ensuring that insights from youth across marginalized communities directly influenced policy recommendations on youth unemployment and social cohesion.
- Led the development and execution of a comprehensive youth engagement strategy, mobilizing 450+ youth through focus group discussions and roundtable dialogues on governance and human rights issues. Collaborated with key stakeholders, including government entities, CSOs, and educational institutions, to enhance youth participation in decision-making processes at the national and local levels.
- Coordinated multi-sectoral partnerships between NAR, government ministries, and youth-led organizations to deliver a series of high-impact national dialogues, including the Peacebuilding Institute (PBI), which brought together local and international youth to foster reconciliation and shaped policy around post-conflict recovery.

Educational Sabbatical

January 2023 – December 2024

Master of Business Administration – One League University & Master of Engineering – Stanford University

- After working with several entrepreneurial firms, I recognized a gap in understanding how to methodically address the continent's complex challenges and create sustainable solutions. With a commitment to becoming an intrapreneur within impactful ventures, I pursued an MBA and MSE in Innovation and Entrepreneurship to deepen my knowledge and skills. This sabbatical also provided an opportunity to enhance my people skills and gain exposure to diverse cultures and perspectives, further enriching my ability to work across global teams and drive innovative, sustainable change.

Project Manager (Co-Founder)

October 2021 – November 2022

AC Group Rwanda (RnD Snappe Limited) – Nairobi, Kenya

- Implemented a green energy program that leveraged partnerships between Snappe, Opibus (a green transportation startup) and 500+ vendors (cash-in-cash-out) to position us to be a cleantech start-up. The vendors would be equipped with solar panels and act as charging stations, whilst Opibus would provide our riders with electric bikes in efforts to reduce our carbon footprint.
- Led a team of designers (UX and GTM) to test and build application features. The task constitutes learning and acquiring market-based knowledge and feedback to guide executives' vision whilst building towards the end user's needs. This has successfully allowed us to create different Beta models, run a POC and build an MVP.
- Developed and oversaw the execution of our go-to-market strategy. This involved extensive research strategy, SAAS B2B marketing, leading a 6month long outreach program and training of 10+ marketers. This resulted in the acquisition of 100+ bike riders; 1 banking partner (securing a debt book); 1000+ vendors and a partnership with over 500 cash-in-cash-out agents.
- Managed collaboration by building clear workflows across operations, marketing and finance. This task was made possible by the adoption of digital tools such as Jira and leveraging an agile execution model allowing for us to fail fast and innovate. This translated strategy into impactful, implementable project opportunities.
- Coordinated communication between key stakeholders and in-house teams. Key deliverables involved capturing the progress and needs of our 4 in-house teams and communicating them efficiently to board members to seek out provision and additional funding. In addition, this function extended into forming a digital presence and building relationships with clients and international donors.

Business Development Manager (Jr)**January 2021 – November 2021***Rottwyler Beverages Ltd – Nairobi, Kenya*

- Collaborated with the regional team to build prospective pipelines and innovate the firm's portfolio. This involved product strategy, financial analysis and business case development, compliance and technical review. This led to the creation of their alcoholic brands; Kiki and Pablo that are now their cash cow products.
- Managed day-to-day operations including but not limited to export management, inventory management, relationships management and marketing. Managed to pique the interest of legacy brands such as Slater & Whittaker. In addition, this informed the move from energy drinks to premixed canned cocktails to meet market needs.
- Developed an expansion playbook. This was reflective of the company's past and a strategic guide to its desired future. It defined the firm's expansion roadmap to insure sustainable short-term cross-border expansion.
- Maintained regular cadence of reporting. This ensured the team at HQ was able to make data-driven decisions and optimize towards our desired growth targets and operational efficiency.

Assistant to Project Lead (Contractual)**2018 – 2019***Smart Africa Secretariat – Kigali, Rwanda*

- Initiated and managed collaborative projects with external partners, which includes drafting MoUs, periodic reporting and ensuring OAF policies are followed in all communication and results sharing.
- Developed an attendee acquisition strategy leveraging digital marketing and storytelling. This involved multiple market surveys and communication outreach campaigns to gauge and leverage target audiences' interest. This joint effort between myself, operational teams and the project lead played a major role in attracting our pool of 1000+ guest delegates at Transform Africa Summit.
- Partnered with the team to identify key industry players and drafting effective communications to inspire them to fund the project both in terms of liquid cash and amenities. We secured partnerships with Gear House SA, JKK, Plan it Swiss and the Radisson to ensure all event logistics were in place for the Transform Africa Summit.
- Managed a team of 18 Personal Assistants (PA's) that were assigned the task of acting as country advisers to our 500+ international VIP and guests.

Anti-Fraud Analyst**September 2016 – September 2017***AC Group Rwanda – Kigali, Rwanda*

- Designed a revenue reporting system under Ops, which created an analytical view on revenue inflow hourly from bus companies. This system has been adopted in Rwanda and Cameroon.
- Designed a data collection feedback process loop and analyzed responses that were later used to guide strategy.

SPECIAL PROJECTS

Expansion Research Consult**January 2021 – January 2021***AC Group Rwanda – Nairobi, Kenya*

- Carried out extensive marketing research to inform their expansion into the Kenyan market. This research was focused on the Matatu industry; Cash-In-Cash-Out networks; Last-mile agent systems and Transport regulations and compliance locally.
- Collaborated with a team two to design and deliver a business plan and strategy document highlighting best strategies and practice to enter the Kenyan market. Key reflections included; funding opportunities, partnerships and innovation technology.

Business Development Specialist**June 2020 – November 2020***SOUK Farms Ltd – Kigali, Rwanda*

- Researched and compiled data sheet of 300+ viable international client. This led to sustainable expansion into the European and UAE markets increasing our annual revenue by an estimated 50% for avocado exports.
- Manipulated data to create and tell our story. This saw an improvement in our overall brand image, an ease in investor/shareholder procurement and facilitated VC fund sourcing.

Assistant to the Director of Partnerships/COS**July 2019 – November 2019***African Institute for Science and Mathematics (AIMS) – Kigali, Rwanda*

- Assisted the project lead in drafting communications to important stakeholders within and outside the organization. This effort led to the securing of funds geared toward our year's objectives, this is; offering free education to 100+ young female leaders in STEM.
- Created and managed a complex data set comprising of key partners and sponsors organizations, amongst other highly regarded government and non-government officials. This aided their raising \$54,000,000 USD for their Development and Research projects.

Advisory Committee (Intern)**July 2019 – November 2019***Gender Summit 2021 – Canada, Rwanda, Nairobi*

- Supported planning, implementation and reporting on gender equality and inclusion events for the Gender Summit – Africa, a platform that brings together over 200 scientists, policymakers, gender scholars and stakeholders in scientific systems.
- Conducted extensive research on the impact of innovation technology on agriculture and challenges/opportunities within the sector. This information aided in the creation of communication campaigns and guided the event program discussion topics.

Consumer and Investment Management Division (Intern)**May 2019 – April 2019***Goldman Sachs – London, United Kingdom*

- Collaborated with a team of four in an asset allocation mock-up, that entailed analyzing and preparing a fact sheet on Goldman's Fixed Income Plus (Hedged) Portfolio for a global pension firm to aid in investment of \$4,000,000.
- Created a market outlook on India, that facilitated and guided the German team in providing concise intel to their investor during their quarterly review.

Underwriting Trainee**July 2018 – October 2018***African Reinsurance Cooperation – Ebene, Mauritius*

- Researched and compiled macroeconomic and political environment statistics of African, Asian, Portuguese and Island Regions for the 2018 Millennium Challenge Corporation (MCC) Report.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Leadership**Student Representative Council (Clubs and Societies Rep)****September 2018 – December 2019***African Leadership University – Kigali, Rwanda*

- Successfully secured \$4,000 worth of equipment for a week-long exposition that was attended by 500 plus students.
- Designed a constitution that facilitated and oversaw the on-boarding of 14 clubs and societies.

Volunteer*Smartix Education – Accra, Ghana***July 2020 – July 2020***One Dollar Back to School (Founder) – Nairobi, Kenya***January 2018 – December 2020****Certificates**

- Google; Digital Skills for Africa
- Stanford Online; Empathize and Prototyping
- University of Geneva; Understanding Financial Markets
- Stanford Online; Cultivating the Entrepreneurial Mindset
- Stanford Online; Building Business Models
- University of Geneva; Meeting Investor Goals
- Yale; Introduction to Negotiations: A Strategic Playbook for Becoming a Persuasive Negotiator
- University of Geneva; Portfolio and Risk Management
- University of Geneva; Securing Investment Returns in the Long Run
- African Leadership University; First Class Honors in International Business and Trade